

D. James Poer

UX Engineer | Design Systems | Front-End Architecture

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

UX Engineer and front-end architect with 12+ years translating design intent, product requirements, and complex business rules into accessible production interfaces. Deep experience with TypeScript, Angular, reusable component patterns, design-system thinking, coded UX solutions, and enterprise UI modernization. Known for resolving ambiguity across Design, Product, and Engineering; reducing UX-related technical debt; and improving accessibility and consistency across large regulated platforms. Completed MIT xPRO training in designing and building AI products and services.

CORE EXPERTISE

Design systems and shared UI patterns | Reusable components and UI architecture | TypeScript and Angular | HTML5, CSS, Sass, JavaScript | Accessibility, WCAG 2.1 and Section 508 | Interaction design and responsive UX | Coded prototyping | Front-end modernization and technical debt | Figma and Justinmind | Cross-functional discovery | Agile delivery | AI-enabled product and workflow design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

EXL LifePRO - Senior Web Designer / UX Engineer

Indianapolis, IN | Oct 2019 - Apr 2023

Enterprise policy-administration platform for life, annuity, and health insurance carriers.

- Designed and delivered production UX/UI for LifePRO Web releases v20, v21, and v22, translating complex insurance workflows and design intent into consistent Angular interfaces used by major carriers.
- Led Section 508 remediation across a large Angular application and prevented a proposed 1.5-million-line HTML rewrite by correcting systemic accessibility defects with roughly 150 lines of reusable Sass.
- Built and maintained an independent Angular v7-to-v10 modernization path, exposing breaking risks in Ivy, Bootstrap 3, and legacy PrimeNG dependencies before they reached product delivery.
- Identified redundant wrapper components, tightly coupled UI abstractions, and inconsistent patterns that were increasing compile times, code volume, and maintenance cost; advised teams on system-level front-end corrections.
- Partnered with product managers, business analysts, senior technology leaders, and offshore engineers to clarify requirements, validate feasibility, align interaction behavior, and reduce downstream rework.
- Turned accessibility standards into an actionable implementation plan for a newly acquired U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs client and advised senior leadership on international accessibility expectations for EU expansion.

Indianapolis Public Schools - UI Developer

Indianapolis, IN | Aug 2019 - Oct 2019

- Built production PowerSchool forms and interaction logic with JavaScript, jQuery, HTML, and CSS, embedding federal and state reporting rules directly into the user workflow.
- Prevented invalid submissions through coded validation and clear interface behavior, improving data quality and reducing district compliance risk.

The Consultant's Consortium - UX Developer

Indianapolis, IN | May 2015 - Jun 2019

Enterprise SaaS platforms for state regulatory agencies.

- Led UX design and front-end development for Angular applications supporting licensing, inspections, regulatory reporting, and public-safety workflows in Oregon, New Jersey, and Michigan.
- Created reusable interface patterns and production components that aligned complex agency rules with consistent, usable workflows across data-dense applications.
- Conducted usability studies and worked directly with product sponsors, subject-matter experts, business analysts, and engineers during discovery to validate needs, feasibility, and implementation constraints.
- Owned WCAG and Section 508 quality across multiple deployments and trained developers in accessibility, semantic HTML5, Sass, and maintainable front-end practices.
- Established a BA-UX collaboration model that brought user needs, regulatory requirements, and engineering constraints together before and throughout development.
- Modernized corporate and product websites in .NET / C# / ASP.NET environments and collaborated closely with backend developers on data, system logic, and integration requirements.

Dreyer and Reinbold Automotive Group - Digital Presence Coordinator

Indianapolis, IN | Sep 2011 - May 2015

- Managed and developed 11 responsive dealership websites across five automotive brands, maintaining consistent digital experiences within vendor and brand constraints.

EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Indiana University, School of Informatics - Bachelor of Science in Informatics

Purdue University - Certificate of Applied Computer Science | Cumulative GPA 3.49 | Major GPA 3.97

MIT xPRO - Designing and Building AI Products and Services | Completed 2026 | 4.80 CEUs

Additional training: AI for Everyone, Customer Experience Specialist, ITIL Foundation, TestDome Angular and HTML/CSS, UX Refresher.